Contents

AMIS MARKET MONITOR

No. 86 – March 2021

Production forecasts for all AMIS crops have been scaled up since last month. However, continued brisk trade activity and strong demand have kept international prices generally elevated near their January highs. With maize production estimates for 2020/21 becoming firmer, the focus is shifting to wheat production prospects for the 2021/22 season. Early forecasts suggest a modest year-on-year increase in global wheat production, with a strong rebound in output in the EU and a possible record crop in India outweighing production drops in Australia and the Russian Federation.

Markets at a glance

	From previous forecast	From previous season
Wheat	▲	▲
Maize	▲	▼
Rice	▲	▬
Soybeans	▼	▼

▲ Easing ▬ Neutral ▼ Tightening

The **Market Monitor** is a product of the Agricultural Market Information System (AMIS). It covers international markets for wheat, maize, rice and soybeans, giving a synopsis of major market developments and the policy and other market drivers behind them. The analysis is a collective assessment of the market situation and outlook by the ten international organizations and entities that form the AMIS Secretariat.

Feature article

For grains, oilseeds and rice, the outlook for the next five years points to a continued rise in production and trade

According to the latest five-year projection of the International Grains Council, there should be no complacency about global food production and trade.

If growth in average yields matches recent trends, and assuming normal weather, global grain production (comprising wheat and coarse grains) is projected at successive records. The increases in production will be sufficient to keep pace with demand growth, but will allow little rebuilding of stocks.

While the rate of stock depletion for maize (corn) is projected to slow compared with the recent seasons, the outlook for world maize supply and demand remains tight. In comparison, world balance sheets for other grains remain relatively comfortable, with further wheat stock accumulation projected to new peaks, and only minor changes over the baseline for other grains.

International grain trade is seen expanding by an average rate of 2 percent annually, led by higher shipments of wheat and maize. While annual increases are expected to be slower than in recent years, rising feed needs will continue to drive growth in maize shipments, with China a regular buyer of sizeable volumes. Expanding milling wheat imports account for much of the growth in wheat trade.

For soybeans, assuming area gains and improvements in productivity, global production is predicted to hit successive peaks during the medium-term, but with growth likely to slow after an initially solid increase in 2021/22. The markets in Asia and the Americas will continue to shape the pattern of soymeal demand during the next five years, with food and industrial (biodiesel) sectors also set to contribute to growth in soy oil usage. A modest uptrend in world inventories is anticipated, tied to gains in major exporters.

World soybeans trade is set to grow progressively, albeit at a slower pace than in the past, with China's share of the world total staying at about 60 percent. Other buyers in Asia are set to secure a higher share of the total, while the EU will remain an important market given the likelihood of tight local rapeseed supplies. Brazil will remain the preeminent supplier.

World rice production is anticipated to trend higher in the next five years. Gains will predominantly be due to improved yields as prospects for area growth in the major rice producing regions of Asia appear limited. By contrast, while remaining a relatively small producing region, sub-Saharan African output is expected to grow especially quickly as policy initiatives to promote production may encourage planting.

While population growth will continue to underpin larger food requirements through to 2025/26, changing consumer preferences in Far East Asia, the world's biggest consuming region, may contain growth in food uptake of rice. This includes China, where stocks are tentatively seen stabilising in the coming years amid official efforts to better manage inventories and maintain crop quality. Nevertheless, global inventories are likely to continue growing, led by gains in India. Trade is projected to expand as larger requirements in sub-Saharan Africa underpin demand, while India is seen remaining the world's biggest exporter.

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World supply-demand outlook

- **Wheat*** 2020 production lifted further on upward revisions for Australia, the EU, Kazakhstan, and the Russian Federation, boosting global production up by 1.7 percent year-on-year (y/y) to a new record.
- Utilization in 2020/21 still up y/y but trimmed this month, mostly on further downgrades to feed wheat usage in the EU due to high prices relative to other feed grains.
- Trade in 2020/21 (July/June) set to surpass the 2019/20 level by 1.2 percent with larger-than-earlier anticipated import prospects in China and Turkey.
- Stocks (ending in 2021) scaled up further this month, resulting in global inventories to increase by as much as 5.4 percent y/y to a new record.

Wheat	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC	
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 4 Feb	2020/21 f'cast 4 Mar	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 9 Feb	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 25 Feb
Prod	760.7	766.5	774.0	763.9	773.4	762.0	772.8
	627.1	632.2	639.8	630.3	639.2	628.4	638.5
Supply	1,032.7	1,043.6	1,050.9	1,047.1	1,073.5	1,021.6	1,050.8
	783.8	781.6	788.9	773.7	787.6	769.3	787.6
Utiliz.	750.9	756.1	754.5	747.0	769.3	743.6	756.3
	624.2	626.2	623.6	621.0	629.3	614.7	622.5
Trade	184.3	184.5	186.6	191.4	193.1	184.1	187.8
	177.5	176.5	177.6	186.0	183.1	177.4	178.1
Stocks	276.9	284.3	292.0	300.1	304.2	278.0	294.5
	149.2	145.0	152.7	148.4	149.3	147.9	155.4

- **Maize**** production estimate for 2020 raised further this month on bigger than earlier anticipated outputs in the EU, Ukraine, and several countries in Sub-Sahara Africa, in particular Ghana.
- Utilization in 2020/21 to reach an all-time high supported by 1.5 percent y/y growth in total feed use driven by stronger demand in China, Argentina, Mexico and Brazil.
- Trade forecast for 2020/21 (July/June) lowered by 3 million tonnes following downward adjustments to imports by the EU, followed by cuts in deliveries also in the Republic of Korea and Saudi Arabia.
- Stocks (ending in 2021) scaled up since last month but still pointing to a significant fall from the previous season, largely due to sharp drawdowns in China, the US and the EU.

Maize	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC	
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 4 Feb	2020/21 f'cast 4 Mar	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 9 Feb	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 25 Feb
Prod	1,138.5	1,148.3	1,152.8	1,116.6	1,134.1	1,125.0	1,133.6
	877.7	887.6	892.1	855.8	873.4	864.2	872.9
Supply	1,462.4	1,450.0	1,454.5	1,436.7	1,437.1	1,451.2	1,431.0
	1,040.4	1,039.1	1,043.5	965.7	975.9	985.2	978.5
Utiliz.	1,158.2	1,179.4	1,179.8	1,133.7	1,150.5	1,153.8	1,163.0
	878.9	887.1	887.5	855.7	861.5	870.9	869.1
Trade	174.3	190.1	187.1	175.0	184.2	173.6	184.4
	168.9	170.1	167.1	167.4	160.2	164.3	161.4
Stocks	301.7	273.1	275.7	303.0	286.5	297.2	268.0
	151.4	134.5	137.1	102.5	90.4	105.6	86.5

- **Rice** production in 2020 upgraded on higher expectations for production in India and, to a lesser extent, Tanzania and Iran.
- Utilization in 2020/21 scaled up, resulting in global per caput food intake rising by 1.0 percent y/y.
- Trade in 2021 (January-December) largely unchanged m/m and forecast to stage a 7.0 percent y/y expansion to a three-year high.
- Stocks (2020/21 carry-out) raised slightly and still seen at their second highest volume on record, with India behind much of this month's upward revision.

Rice	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC	
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 4 Feb	2020/21 f'cast 4 Mar	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 9 Feb	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 25 Feb
Prod	502.8	510.6	513.2	497.2	504.0	497.4	503.6
	359.2	365.5	368.0	350.4	355.7	350.7	355.4
Supply	688.2	692.5	695.4	674.1	682.3	673.0	678.0
	439.2	444.0	446.9	412.4	417.5	417.2	419.7
Utiliz.	504.2	512.1	514.4	495.8	504.2	498.6	502.2
	358.3	364.3	366.5	350.6	355.2	352.6	354.6
Trade	45.1	48.4	48.2	44.8	46.1	43.6	45.6
	41.9	45.6	45.4	41.9	43.3	40.8	43.1
Stocks	182.2	181.9	182.5	178.3	178.1	174.4	175.8
	78.8	79.7	80.3	61.8	61.9	61.8	62.6

- **Soybean** 2020/21 production raised marginally on upward adjustments for South American producers following improved weather conditions, thus confirming a strong y/y increase in global output.
- Utilization in 2020/21 lifted slightly, mainly reflecting higher forecasts for the US and China (both on robust domestic crush demand) as well as Argentina (tied to higher production forecasts).
- Trade in 2020/21 (Oct/Sep) virtually unchanged, with yet another upward correction of China's import forecast offset by expectations of lower purchases in the EU.
- Stocks (2020/21 carry-out) lowered again on a bigger drawdown than-earlier-anticipated in the US, driving global inventories down by almost one quarter y/y to a 7-year low.

Soybeans	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC	
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 4 Feb	2020/21 f'cast 4 Mar	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 9 Feb	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast 25 Feb
Prod	338.2	362.2	363.6	336.5	361.1	338.3	359.9
	320.1	342.6	344.0	318.4	341.5	320.1	340.3
Supply	401.4	416.6	418.1	449.3	455.9	402.4	410.8
	372.3	377.6	379.1	411.8	409.5	363.6	362.3
Utiliz.	360.2	373.5	375.1	354.8	369.8	351.5	365.5
	252.1	255.0	256.3	245.6	252.1	240.5	246.8
Trade	169.0	169.8	169.7	165.2	169.7	169.8	169.5
	70.4	69.6	69.0	66.9	66.7	68.6	67.7
Stocks	54.8	43.1	42.6	94.9	83.4	50.9	45.3
	35.4	22.7	22.0	68.1	54.8	21.8	13.8

in million tonnes

Data shown in the second rows refer to world aggregates without China; world trade data refer to exports and world trade without China excludes exports to China.
To review and compare data, by country and commodity, across three main sources, go to https://app.amis-outlook.org/#/market-database/compare-sources
Estimates and forecasts may differ across sources for many reasons, including different methodologies.
** For early 2021 production forecasts see page 4.*
***The 2020/21 AMIS-FAO world maize production forecast includes southern hemisphere maize crops harvested in 2020 whereas IGC and USDA include southern hemisphere maize crops to be harvested in 2021 in their 2020/21 world production numbers.*
For more information see Explanatory notes on the last page of this report.

Revisions (FAO-AMIS) to 2020/21 forecasts since the previous report

in thousand tonnes

	WHEAT				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	***7507***	***2097***	***-1584***	***2032***	***7700***
Total AMIS	***8132***	***574***	***-1642***	***2262***	***6404***
Argentina	400	-	500	-500	100
Australia	2,172	-	198	500	974
Brazil	-	-	-	400	-200
Canada	-	-	400	-	-400
China Mainland	-	1,000	1,000	-	-
Egypt	-	-	-	-	-451
EU	916	-900	-1,800	500	1316
India	-	-	200	-200	-
Indonesia	-	-200	-600	-	-
Japan	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	1,756	-	-	1,000	756
Mexico	15	-350	-485	-	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-	-	-	-	-
Russian Fed.	2,873	-	-	1,000	1,762
Saudi Arabia	-	-100	-	-	-100
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-
Thailand	-	-	-	-	-
Turkey	-	1,500	-	-500	2,000
Ukraine	-	-	-	-	-
UK	-	-	-856	50	806
US	-	-	-	-	-
Viet Nam	-	-376	-199	12	-159

	MAIZE				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	***4492***	***-3012***	***369***	***-3029***	***2605***
Total AMIS	***2433***	***-3030***	***-937***	***-3329***	***2496***
Argentina	-	-	-	-	-
Australia	-	-	-	-	-
Brazil	-	-	-	-500	-
Canada	-	-	-	-	-
China Mainland	-	-	-	-	-
Egypt	-	-	-	-	-
EU	2096	-3500	-2404	-150	1150
India	-100	-30	-400	-	630
Indonesia	-	-	-	-	-
Japan	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	58	-	-	-	25
Mexico	-150	-	-150	-	-
Nigeria	403	-	403	-	-
Philippines	19	400	269	-	150
Rep. of Korea	-	-500	-200	-	200
Russian Fed.	-525	-	975	-1500	-
Saudi Arabia	-	-200	-200	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-
Thailand	182	-	182	-	-
Turkey	-	-	-	-	-
Ukraine	484	-	-	-	484
UK	-	500	419	-	81
US	-	-	-	-1500	-
Viet Nam	-34	300	169	321	-224

	RICE				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	***2575***	***-177***	***2247***	***-170***	***640***
Total AMIS	***1529***	***147***	***1270***	***-160***	***636***
Argentina	16	2	56	-100	-15
Australia	-	-	36	70	15
Brazil	-	-	-	-	-
Canada	-	60	28	-	-25
China Mainland	-	-	-	-	-
Egypt	-	-	-	-	-
EU	-19	-	-12	-	-50
India	1544	-	978	-20	700
Indonesia	-	-	131	-	-
Japan	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	-12	-	3	-	-15
Mexico	-	-	-	-	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-	-	-	-	-
Russian Fed.	-	-	-10	20	-10
Saudi Arabia	-	-	-	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-
Thailand	-	-	-35	-140	-
Turkey	-	15	5	10	-
Ukraine	-	-	-	-	-
UK	-	-	6	-	5
US	-	-	-	-	31
Viet Nam	-	70	85	-	-

	SOYBEANS				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	***1391***	***-116***	***1659***	***-97***	***-507***
Total AMIS	***841***	***-116***	***1424***	***-217***	***-452***
Argentina	500	-	400	-580	300
Australia	18	-	16	-	2
Brazil	400	-	-	10	100
Canada	-	-	5	-	-100
China Mainland	-	500	300	-	200
Egypt	-	-	-	-	-
EU	-	-600	-100	-	-400
India	-	-	-	-	-
Indonesia	-	-	-	-	-
Japan	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	-	-	-	-	-
Mexico	-	-	-	-	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-	-	-	-	-
Russian Fed.	-	-	-	-	-
Saudi Arabia	-	-	-	-	-
South Africa	-15	-181	-21	-2	-27
Thailand	-	-	-	-	-
Turkey	-	-	-	-	-
Ukraine	-62	-	125	-145	-3
UK	-	-	-	-	-
US	-	-	550	500	-550
Viet Nam	-	165	149	-	26

Wheat production: leading producers

A preliminarily forecast for global wheat production in 2021 points to a third year of consecutive increase, reaching 780 million tonnes, a new record. The bulk of the projected growth is expected to come from the EU, where wheat plantings are forecast to recover from last year's low, increasing by more than 5 percent in 2021.

For more detailed information, see the March issue of FAO Cereal Supply and Demand Brief at http://www.fao.org/worldfoodsituation and the March issue of FAO Crop Prospects and Food Situation. http://www.fao.org/giews/reports/crop-prospects

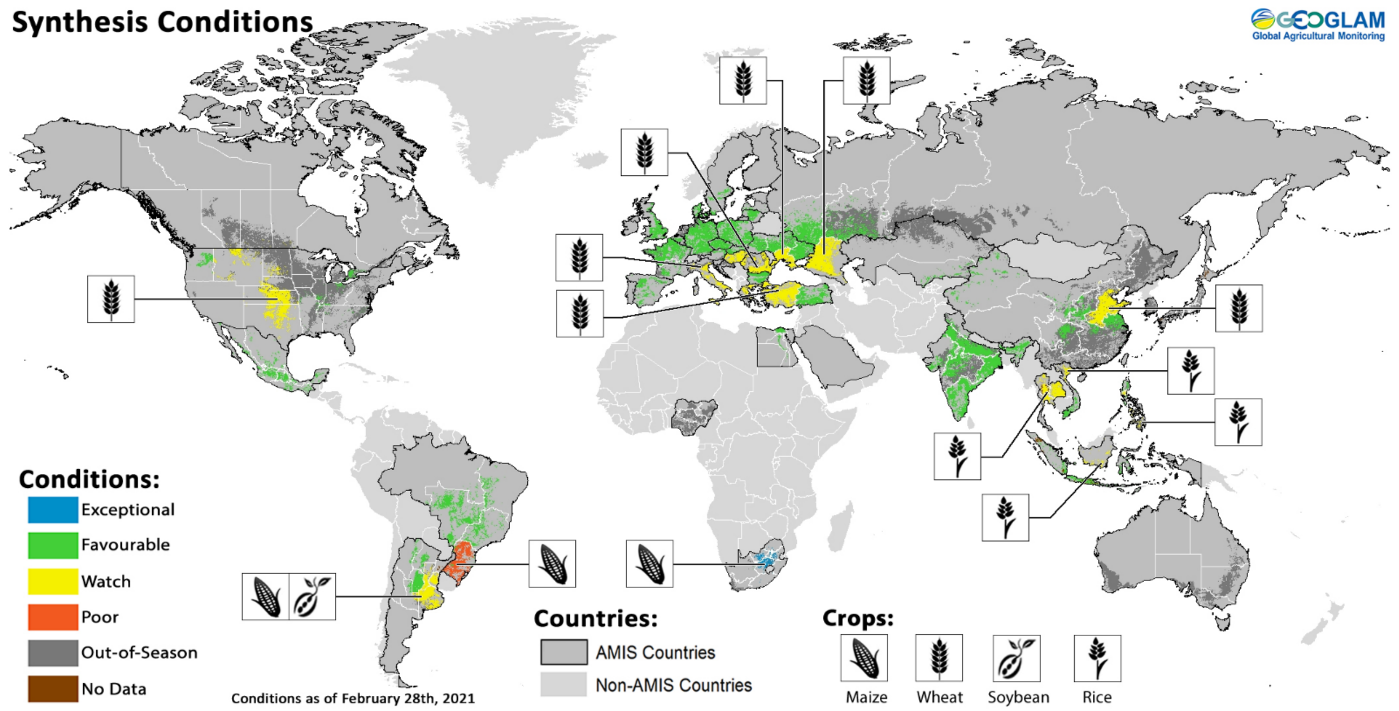
Wheat production				
	2019	**2020 est**	**2021 f'cast**	**Change: 2021 over 2020**
		million tonnes		
WORLD	***760.7***	***774.0***	***780.0***	***0.8%***
Argentina	19.8	17.6	19.0	***8.0%***
Australia	15.2	33.3	26.0	***-22.0%***
Canada	32.3	35.2	33.0	***-6.2%***
China (Mainland)	133.6	134.2	135.5	***0.9%***
Egypt	9.0	9.0	9.0	***0.0%***
EU*	155.7	125.2	137.0	***9.4%***
India	103.6	107.6	109.0	***1.3%***
Iran	14.5	14.0	14.5	***3.6%***
Kazakhstan	11.5	14.3	14.0	***-1.8%***
Russian Fed.	74.5	85.9	79.0	***-8.0%***
Pakistan	24.4	25.3	26.0	***3.0%***
Turkey	19.0	20.5	19.5	***-4.9%***
Ukraine	28.3	25.1	26.0	***3.6%***
UK	-	9.7	14.0	***45.0%***
US	52.6	49.7	50.0	***0.6%***
Other countries	66.9	67.5	68.5	***1.5%***

Source: FAO-AMIS

**Data for the European Union from the year 2020 excludes the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland.*

Crop monitor

Crop conditions in AMIS countries (as of 28 February)



Crop condition map synthesizing information for all four AMIS crops as of 28 February. Crop conditions over the main growing areas for wheat, maize, rice, and soybean are based on a combination of national and regional crop analyst inputs along with earth observation data. ***Only crops that are in other-than-favourable conditions are displayed on the map with their crop symbol.***

Conditions at a glance

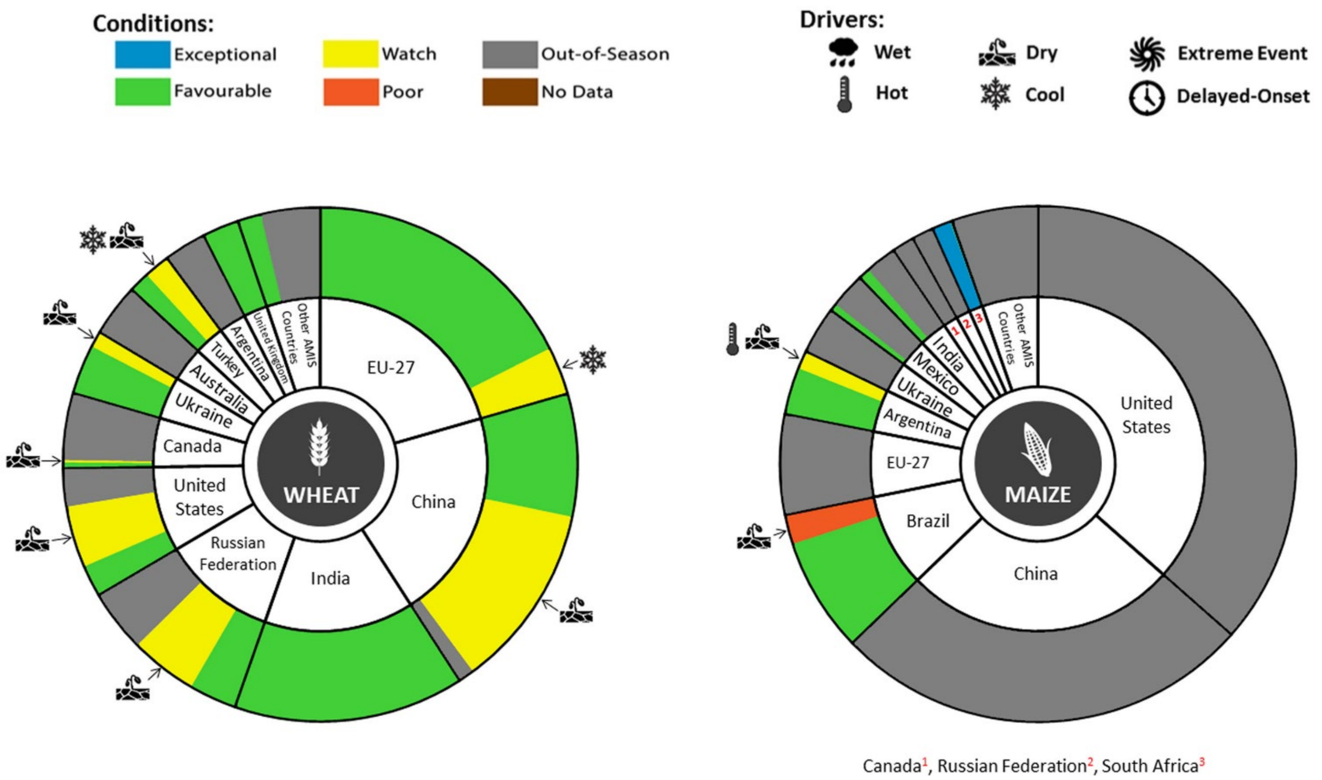
Wheat - In the northern hemisphere, areas of concern for winter wheat remain in parts of the EU, China, the Russian Federation, Ukraine, Turkey, the US, and Canada.
Maize - In the southern hemisphere, conditions are mixed in Brazil for the spring-planted crops and the late-planted crop in Argentina. Conditions in South Africa are exceptional.

Rice – Rabi rice in India is under favourable conditions. In Southeast Asia, wet-season rice in Indonesia and dry-season rice in the northern countries are under mixed conditions. Harvesting has begun in Brazil.
Soybeans - In the southern hemisphere, conditions are generally favourable in Brazil, while Argentina is under mixed conditions.

La Niña advisory

The El Niño-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) is currently in the La Niña phase. This La Niña event is well developed, with below-average ocean temperatures in the central-eastern equatorial Pacific and tropical atmosphere circulation consistent with La Niña. The conditions are expected to continue (~80 percent chance for February to April and ~60 percent chance for March to May) and then transition to ENSO neutral (60 percent chance for April to June).

La Niña conditions typically reduce March-to-May rainfall in East Africa, the northern Middle East, southern Central Asia, Afghanistan, Pakistan, and the southern United States. La Niña conditions typically increase March-to-May rainfall in Southeast Asia and March-to-April rainfall in Southern Africa. Southernmost India and Sri Lanka typically see increased rainfall into March.



Wheat

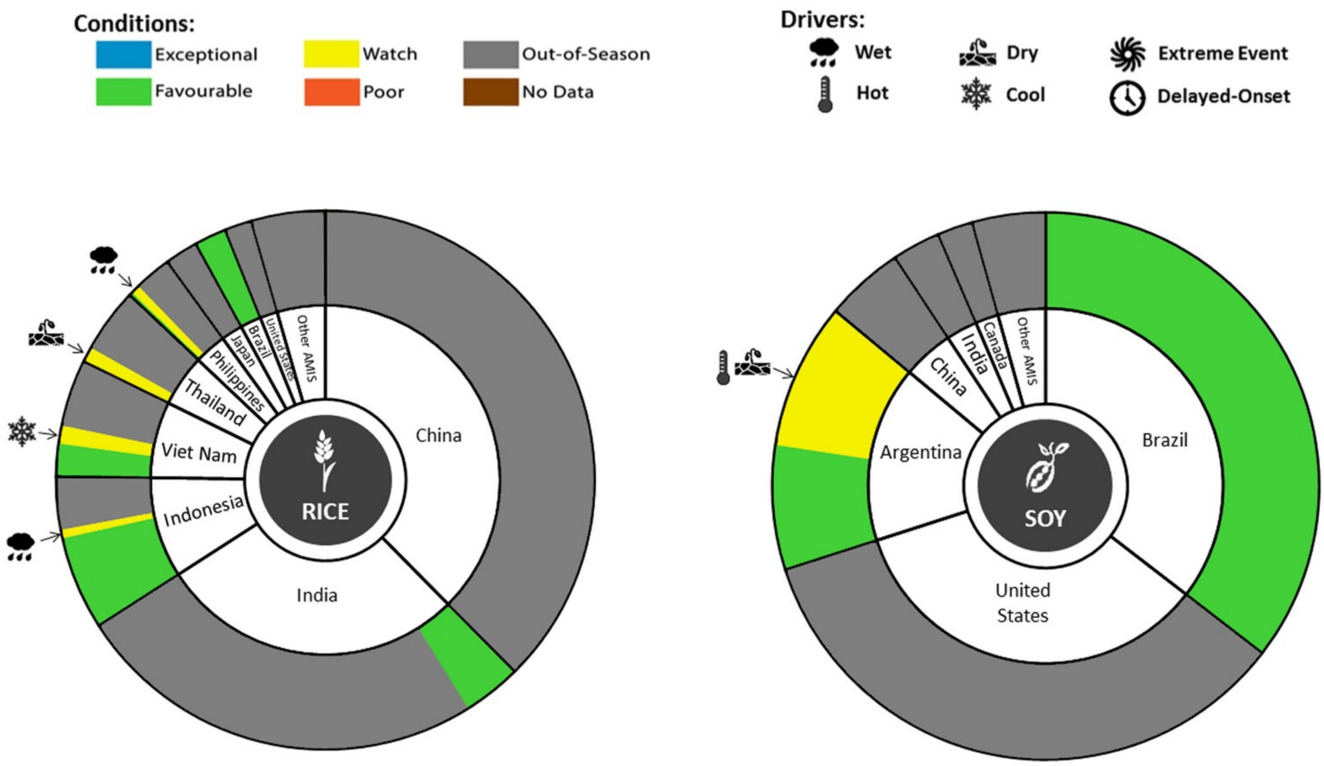
In the **EU**, conditions are generally favourable for winter wheat with some minor areas of concern in south-eastern Europe due to a recent cold spell, which may have affected crops with limited snow cover. In the **UK**, conditions are favourable. In **Ukraine**, conditions are generally favourable with adequate snow cover protection; however, below-average soil moisture in the south may affect crops in the spring. In the **Russian Federation**, conditions remain mixed for winter wheat due to continuing dry conditions since last fall in the Southern and North Caucasus. In **Turkey**, conditions are mixed due to continuing dry conditions and recent cold weather that may have led to winterkill. In **China**, conditions are mixed for winter wheat with below-average rainfall in the east reducing crop growth. In **India**, conditions are favourable with an increase in total sown area compared to last year. In the **US**, winter wheat continues are under watch conditions due to dryness and recent below-average temperatures throughout the Great Plains. In **Canada**, conditions are favourable in the main producing province of Ontario; however, below-average snowfall in the Prairies along with recent cold weather has placed the crop at risk of winterkill.

Maize

In **Mexico**, sowing of the autumn-winter crop (smaller season) is ongoing under favourable conditions. In **Brazil**, conditions are mixed for the spring-planted crop (smaller season) as the harvest begins. A lack of rains in the main producing South Region during the critical grain-filling stage has noticeably reduced yields. However, the remaining regions are under favourable conditions. Sowing of the summer-planted (larger season) crop is ongoing under favourable conditions with an expected increase in total sown area compared to last year mainly in the Northeast, Central-West and South regions. In **Argentina**, conditions have improved for the early-planted crop (usually larger season); however, a lack of February rains and high temperatures has affected the late-planted crop (usually smaller season) while going through critical developmental stages. Pockets of dry conditions remain, particularly in La Pampa, with early-planted crops affected more than late-planted crops. Due to a lack of rainfall in the spring, a large amount of crop sowing shifted to the late-planted season, making the two seasons about the same size this year. In **India**, conditions are favourable for the Rabi crop. In **South Africa**, conditions are exceptional with ample rainfall bolstering the crop.

Pie chart description: *Each slice represents a country's share of total AMIS production (5-year average), with the main producing countries (95 percent of production) shown individually and the remaining 5 percent grouped into the "Other AMIS Countries" category. Sections within each country are weighted by the sub-national production statistics (5-year average) of the respective country and accounts for multiple cropping seasons (i.e. spring and winter wheat).*

The late vegetative through to reproductive crop growth stages are generally the most sensitive periods for crop development.



Rice

In **India**, Rabi rice is under favourable conditions as transplanting is wrapping up in the eastern states. In **Indonesia**, harvesting of wet-season rice is ongoing under mixed conditions due to flooding in South Kalimantan. Yields of earlier sown crops are slightly lower compared to last year due to a reduction in rainfall earlier in the season. In **Viet Nam**, conditions are favourable in the south as the sowing of the winter-spring (dry-season) crop is complete, and harvesting has begun in some Mekong River Delta provinces. In the north, sowing of the winter-spring (dry-season) crop has begun and is expected to see a reduction in total sown area compared to last year due to cold weather. In **Thailand**, dry-season rice remains under mixed conditions due to a lack of irrigation water, which is also expected to reduce the total sown area this year compared to last year. In the **Philippines**, dry-season rice is under mixed conditions as flooding has damaged crops in the provinces of Western and Eastern Visayas and some provinces of Mindanao. In **Brazil**, harvest has begun under favourable conditions. Total sown area has increased compared to last year.

Soybeans

In **Brazil**, harvesting is ongoing under favourable conditions, albeit delayed compared to the average due to the late start to the season. There is an increase in total sown area compared to last year. In **Argentina**, conditions are mixed across both the early-planted crop (larger season) and the late-planted crop (smaller season) as a lack of rainfall along with high temperatures in February has affected the crops particularly in Buenos Aires, La Pampa, Santa Fe and Entre Ríos. The crops are currently going through critical developmental stages and additional rainfall is needed to ensure good yields.

Information on crop conditions in non-AMIS countries can be found in the GEOGLAM Early Warning Crop Monitor, published 4 March 2021

Sources and Disclaimers: The Crop Monitor assessment is conducted by GEOGLAM with inputs from the following partners (in alphabetical order): Argentina (Buenos Aires Grains Exchange, INTA), Asia Rice Countries (AFSIS, ASEAN+3 & Asia RiCE), Australia (ABARES & CSIRO), Brazil (CONAB & INPE), Canada (AAFC), China (CAS), EU (EC JRC MARS), Indonesia (LAPAN & MOA), International (CIMMYT, FAO, IFPRI & IRRI), Japan (JAXA), Mexico (SIAP), Russian Federation (IKI), South Africa (ARC & GeoTerraImage & SANSA), Thailand (GISTDA & OAE), Ukraine (NASU-NSAU & UHMC), USA (NASA, UMD, USGS – FEWS NET, USDA (FAS, NASS)), Viet Nam (VAST & VIMHE-MARD). The findings and conclusions in this joint multiagency report are consensual statements from the GEOGLAM experts, and do not necessarily reflect those of the individual agencies represented by these experts.
More detailed information on the GEOGLAM crop assessments is available at www.geoglam-crop-monitor.org

Policy developments

Wheat

- On 16 February, **Canada's** Pest Management Regulatory Agency (PMRA) notified the WTO of new proposed maximum residue limits (MRLs) for the Propiconazole used on wheat. (G/SPS/N/CAN/1374; Deadline for comments 27/04/2021).
- On 8 February, **China** notified the WTO of the adoption of technical regulations that specify the terms and definitions, classification, quality requirements, test methods, inspection rules, labelling, packaging, storage and transportation requirements for wheat. (G/TBT/N/CHN/1538)

Maize

- On 15 February, **Japan** notified the WTO of the adoption of MRLs for the plant protection chemical Tolpyralate, which is used on maize. (G/SPS/N/JPN/775/Add.1)

Soybeans

- On 11 February, **Brazil** notified the WTO of the adoption of MRLs for pesticide *Flupyradifurone* which is used on soybeans. (G/SPS/N/BRA/1741/Add.1)
- On 8 February, **China** notified the WTO of a new technical regulation that specifies the terms and definitions, classification, quality requirements, test methods, inspection rules, labelling, packaging, storage and transportation requirements for soybeans. (G/TBT/N/CHN/1529)

Biofuels

- On 3 February, to enhance the Ethanol Blended Petrol Programme, which aims at a 20 percent blending target by 2030, **India** increased the ex-mill prices of ethanol produced from various feedstocks such as sugarcane and damaged surplus rice. To increase ethanol production, new interest subvention schemes were also announced to encourage the establishment of new production units, or expansion of existing distilleries (molasses and grain-based); the setting up of dual feed distilleries, etc.

Across the board

- On 9 February, **Canada** notified the WTO of the establishment of MRLs for *Tetraconazole,* which is used on several crops including wheat and maize. (G/SPS/N/CAN/1351/Add.1)
- On 21 February, **China's** State Council issued the "No.1 Central Document" setting out for 2021-2025 the priorities for agriculture modernization, rural development policy, poverty alleviation and food security. Amid population growth and an increasingly unpredictable external environment due to the pandemic, China is set to build a "national food security industry belt" and prioritize the seed sector. According to the document, at least 120 million hectares of arable land would be required to ensure an adequate and stable supply of grains and other essential agricultural products.
- On 1 February, amid the on-going pandemic, the **European Commission** extended the exemptions from competition rules that were initially instituted under the State Aid Temporary Framework until 31 December 2021. The level of assistance that individual EU member States may grant to each agricultural firm was more than doubled, i.e. from EUR 100 000 to EUR 225 000 (from USD 120 613 to USD 271 379).
- On 15 February, **Germany** issued regulations to gradually phase out the sale and use of glyphosate-based herbicides by the end of 2023 to protect biodiversity and prevent water pollution from pesticide use (Insect Protection Act; and Plant Protection Application Ordinance).
- On 12 February, the **European Union** notified the WTO of the adoption of MRLs for *carbon tetrachloride, chlorothalonil, chlorpropham, dimethoate, ethoprophos, fenamidone, methiocarb, omethoate, propiconazole and pymetrozine,* which are used on wheat, maize and rice. (G/SPS/N/EU/394/Add.1)
- On 1 February, the **Indian** Ministry of Finance and Corporate affairs announced a target of INR 16.5 trillion (USD 223 billion) in farm loans for the next fiscal year 2021/22 (compared to INR 15 trillion in the current fiscal year 2020/21). A series of measures to support an inclusive agriculture sector were also announced. Existing schemes are to be upgraded to bring transparency in property ownership. Farm credit allocations will reach INR 16.5 trillion (USD 223 billion) in financial year 2022 (primarily to animal husbandry, dairy and fisheries); the Rural Infrastructure Fund is increased by 33 percent to INR 400 billion (USD 5.5 billion); the Micro-Irrigation Fund will double to INR 100 billion (USD 1.37 billion); support to increase value addition and exports will be available to 22 perishable products, instead of 3, under the Operation Green Scheme.

AMIS Policy database

Visit the AMIS Policy database at: *http://statistics.amis-outlook.org/policy/*

*The **AMIS Policy database** gathers information on trade measures and domestic measures related to the four AMIS crops (wheat, maize, rice, and soybeans) as well as biofuels. The design of this database allows comparisons across countries, across commodities and across policies for selected periods of time.*

*Only AMIS participants are marked in **bold**.*

- On 15 February, **Japan** notified the WTO of the establishment of pesticide MRLs *Imazapyr* which is used on wheat, maize and soybeans. (G/SPS/N/JPN/774/Add.1)
- On 25 February, following protests against efforts to liberalize the agricultural sector, the President of **Kazakhstan** announced a ban on the sale or leasing of agriculture land to foreign individuals, foreign legal entities, as well as legal entities with foreign shareholders.
- On 4 February, **Russia's** Ministry of Economic Development announced that export taxes for wheat, maize and barley will, from 2 June onwards, be calculated using a new formula. Under the formula, the export tax will be set at 70 percent of the difference between a calculated base price and USD 200 per tonne (for wheat) or USD 185 per tonne (for maize and barley). From 1 April, Russian grain exporters will be requested to declare the price of their contracts to the Moscow Exchange, which will then calculate the base price for the formula. The tax will be recalculated and published every week on the last working day of the week and will be implemented from the third working day after publication.
- On 20 February, **the Russian Federation** issued a draft law to ensure quality control of imported seeds for grain, vegetables and other crops, in particular to prevent the entry of genetically modified (GM) seeds into its territory.

Trade Junctures and Logistics

- On 18 February, **India's** largest rice handling facility Kakinada Anchorage Port opened another port, Kakinada Deepwater Port, to ease congestion and improve the waiting times for shipments which had increased from an expected average of 1 week to 4 weeks.
- On 1 February, several seaport operations in **Ukraine** were blocked due to poor water conditions.
- On 18 February, the **US** Food and Drug Administration released a joint statement with USDA to underscore that there is no credible evidence that either food or food packaging is associated with or is a likely source of viral transmission of the virus causing COVID-19.

Stop press

- On 28 January 2021, **Japan** approved a JPY 1.05 trillion (USD 10.1 billion) supplementary budget of the Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries for the Fiscal Year 2020 (April-March) which may also be used for the following fiscal year. It includes JPY 353 billion (USD 3.3 billion) for COVID-19 support programmes, JPY 322 billion (USD 3.0 billion) for trade agreement countermeasures and JPY 366 billion (USD 3.4 billion) for disaster preparedness and land reinforcement measures, as well as other objectives such as the diversion of table rice to other products. The budget for fiscal year 2021 is expected to be down by around 4.4 percent.

International prices

International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Index (GOI) and GOI sub-Indices

	Feb 2021 Average*	Change M/M	Change Y/Y
GOI	269	+ 0.1 %	+ 39.7 %
Wheat	229	+ 0.0 %	+ 19.8 %
Maize	271	+ 0.9%	+ 45.4 %
Rice	199	+ 0.8 %	+ 17.4 %
Soybeans	273	+ 1.1 %	+ 54.9 %

*Jan 2000=100, derived from daily export quotations

Wheat

On average, world wheat export prices showed little overall change m/m. Support continued to come from less than ideal conditions for 2021/22 crops in some areas, with spells of very cold weather in the US, Black Sea region and Europe seen as a potential threat to production outcomes. Uncertainty about Russia's export tax/quota system added to price volatility. Some market commentators suggested the tax could prompt Russian farmers to plant less spring wheat than previously planned for the 2021 harvest and, in future years, may result in Russia losing its place as the world's top wheat exporter. China remained a strong buyer, including reports of recent large purchases from Australia and Canada, where port loading capacities were reported to be tight following recent heavy sales. Pakistan authorised additional imports by its state buyer, potentially taking total purchases to a 20-year high.

Maize

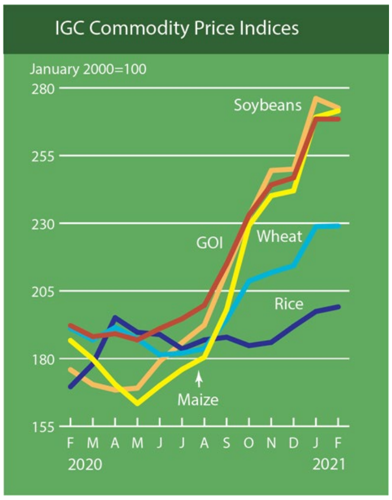
The IGC maize sub-Index rose for a ninth consecutive month. US prices gained on buoyant export demand, especially from China, as well as background worries about occasionally difficult weather for South American crops. A brisk pace of exports also supported values in Brazil, but with spot quotations seen as highly nominal due to tight nearby availabilities and recent planting delays. In contrast, Argentine quotations weakened, as farmers became more active sellers ahead of the imminent harvest, with offers undercutting competing origins, including the US. After very strong advances in the month before, FOB prices in Ukraine dipped slightly.

Rice

Although market activity in much of Asia was subdued amid Lunar New Year celebrations, average international rice prices were stronger m/m. Thai quotes were supported by concerns about off-season output, although weak international demand pared price gains. Prices in India rose on robust buying interest and government paddy procurement, while loading delays showed signs of easing as the first vessel sailed from Kakinada's deep-water port. In Viet Nam, early new crop arrivals and slow demand weighed on offers, but with some support from reports of harvesting delays.

Soybeans

Reflecting losses at all key origins, average soybean values were modestly weaker m/m during February. Despite ongoing harvesting delays, prospects for a heavy Brazilian crop pressured, outweighing underlying support from dwindling US supplies after a season of heavy exports. Softer buying interest from China featured at times, with activity partly muted by the Lunar New Year celebrations, while movements in soybean product values were sometimes influential. Although USDA's projected 8 percent increase in US acreage in 2021/22 mildly weighed, prospects for continued supply tightness were supportive. In Brazil, declines in FOB quotations were amplified by a plunge in export premiums as harvesting advanced, albeit slowly, and port line-ups lengthened ahead of an expected upswing in dispatches in coming weeks.

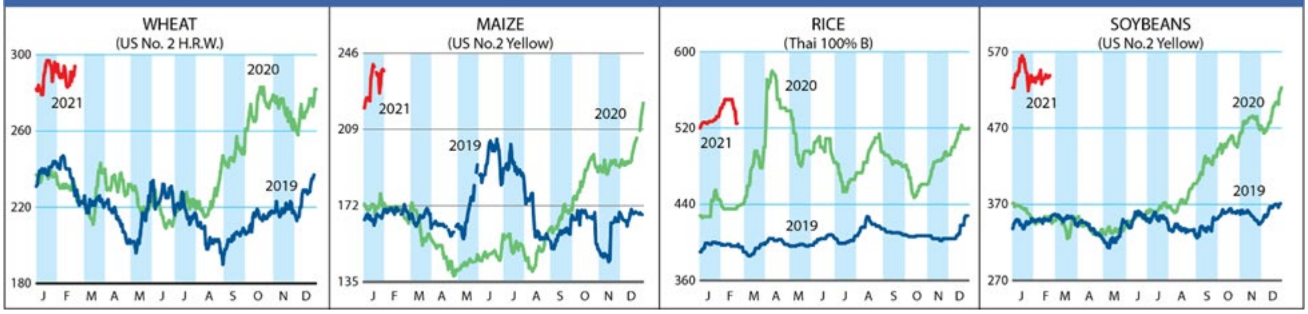


IGC commodity price indices

		GOI	Wheat	Maize	Rice	Soybeans
		(.................January 2000 = 100				...................)
2020	February	**192.2**	191.2	186.7	169.6	175.9
	March	**188.1**	186.9	179.8	178.0	170.4
	April	**189.2**	191.5	170.5	195.1	168.4
	May	**186.9**	187.3	163.4	189.7	169.1
	June	**191.1**	181.4	170.0	188.9	179.0
	July	**194.7**	182.0	176.0	183.6	185.9
	August	**199.7**	183.7	180.5	186.9	192.4
	September	**215.0**	194.5	198.1	187.9	212.3
	October	**233.0**	208.6	229.1	184.8	232.5
	November	**244.2**	211.8	240.2	186.0	249.5
	December	**246.8**	214.3	242.0	191.9	250.0
2021	January	**268.5**	228.8	269.2	197.4	276.1
	February	**268.5**	229.0	271.5	199.1	272.6

Selected export prices, currencies, and indices

Daily quotations of selected export prices (USD/tonne, 2019-2021)



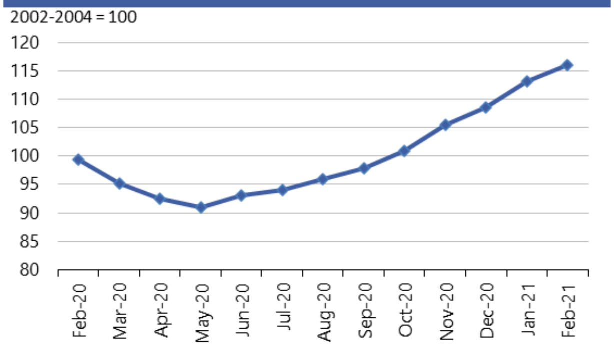
Daily quotations of selected export prices

	Effective Date	Quotation (1)	Month ago (2)	Year ago (3)	% change (1) over (2)	% change (1) over (3)
	USD/tonne					
Wheat (US No. 2, HRW)	26-Feb	287	295	222	-2.7%	29.3%
Maize (US No. 2, Yellow)	26-Feb	249	237	163	4.8%	52.3%
Rice (Thai 100% B)	26-Feb	524	541	440	-3.1%	19.1%
Soybeans (US No.2, Yellow)	26-Feb	546	536	349	1.9%	56.4%

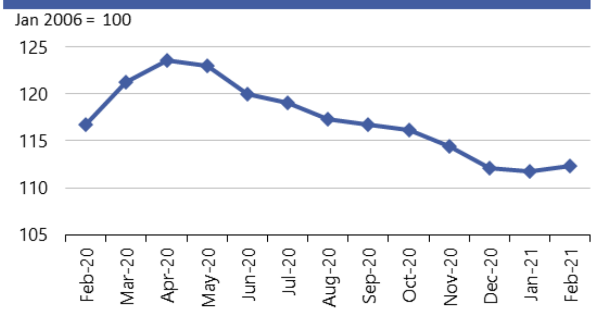
AMIS Countries' Currencies Against US Dollar

AMIS Countries	Currency	Feb 2021 Average	Monthly Change	Annual Change
Argentina	**ARS**	88.6	-3.1%	-30.8%
Australia	**AUD**	1.3	0.5%	16.5%
Brazil	**BRL**	5.4	-0.8%	-19.4%
Canada	**CAD**	1.3	0.3%	4.7%
China	**CNY**	6.5	0.2%	8.3%
Egypt	**EGP**	15.6	0.3%	0.1%
EU	**EUR**	0.8	-0.6%	10.9%
India	**INR**	72.7	0.5%	-1.6%
Indonesia	**IDR**	14,012.4	0.0%	-1.8%
Japan	**JPY**	105.3	-1.5%	4.5%
Kazakhstan	**KZT**	418.4	0.5%	-9.7%
Rep. Korea	**KRW**	1,109.7	-1.0%	7.6%
Mexico	**MXN**	20.2	-1.6%	-6.9%
Nigeria	**NGN**	380.7	0.0%	-19.6%
Philippines	**PHP**	48.2	-0.3%	5.3%
Russian Fed.	**RUB**	74.2	0.1%	-13.6%
Saudi Arabia	**SAR**	3.8	0.0%	0.0%
South Africa	**ZAR**	14.7	2.7%	2.1%
Thailand	**THB**	30.0	0.1%	4.5%
Turkey	**TRY**	7.1	4.7%	-14.2%
UK	**GBP**	0.7	1.7%	7.1%
Ukraine	**UAH**	27.8	1.2%	-11.9%
Viet Nam	**VND**	23,014.2	0.2%	1.0%

FAO Food Price Index
Feb 2020- Feb 2021



Nominal Broad Dollar Index
Feb 2020 - Feb 2021



Source: US Federal Reserve

Futures market (US)

Futures Prices – nearby in USD per tonne

	Feb-21 Average	Change	
		M/M	Y/Y
Wheat	240	-0.5%	18.7%
Maize	217	6.7%	45.7%
Rice	285	-0.1%	-4.1%
Soybeans	505	0.1%	55.2%

Source: CME

Historical Volatility – 30 Days, nearby

	Monthly Averages		
	Feb-21	Jan-21	Feb-20
Wheat	30.7%	28.0%	17.7%
Maize	29.1%	20.5%	19.5%
Rice	17.8%	16.5%	13.5%
Soybeans	23.4%	20.7%	10.2%

Future Prices

Futures prices rose for maize and soybeans, easing slightly for wheat m/m as global agricultural trade remained brisk and other commodities hit multi-year highs. China remained the dominant story, as it shipped record quantities of maize and soybeans from US ports, causing the USDA to cut ending stocks to seven-year lows for both commodities. In Brazil, analysts noted a slow start to the soybean harvest and resultant delays in the safrinha maize planting, while still projecting record harvests there for 2021. Across Europe, recent cold weather was judged to have had minimal impact on winter wheat prospects, while the US cold weather shock extending into the southern plains was still being assessed for winter wheat damage. Rice futures rose modestly on continued Asian demand. In exogenous markets, the US dollar index continued to hover around .90 level for the last three months, although the latest proposed fiscal stimulus plan (coronavirus relief) has caused inflationary concerns with respect to most asset classes, including commodities. Crude oil prices rose to USD 60 per barrel for the first time in a year on a combination of pandemic slowdown, federal policy measures, and economic recovery. Prices for maize, soybeans rose 6.7 and 0.1 percent respectively, m/m, with wheat and rice declining by 0.5 and 0.1 percent respectively. Wheat, maize and soybeans were all higher y/y by 18.7, 45.7 and 55.2 percent while rice was lower by 4.1 percent.

Volumes and volatility

Trade volumes fell modestly for maize and soybeans m/m and rose for wheat. Volumes y/y showed divergent trends, declining for wheat and soybeans while rising for maize. Implied volatility fell slightly m/m for all three commodities but doubled in value for maize and soybeans y/y. Historical volatility, however, showed differing trends – rising m/m and y/y for all three commodities.

Basis levels and transport

Domestic basis levels were steady to firm m/m, reflecting the considerable demand pull on producer-held supplies. In Illinois, average quotes to local elevators were minus USD 3.5 per tonne for maize, and minus USD 4 per tonne for soybeans, each under the respective March futures prices. In Iowa, maize and soybean bids were minus USD 9 and minus USD 16, respectively. Soft red wheat bids to flour mills, continued at a discount to nearby futures. Record export demand and icy river conditions pushed maize and soybean bids delivered gulf to USD 30 and USD 28 per tonne over respective futures m/m. Soft red wheat values were quoted at around USD 40 per tonne over the March futures. Despite reduced barge traffic on the Illinois River due to ice floes, freight levels were slightly weaker at about USD 22 per tonne. The USDA reported that exports and forward sales for maize and soybeans were continuing at a record pace, mostly driven by China. The agency also reported that wheat exports/forward sales surpassed the previous year.

Forward curves

Forward curves for wheat, maize and soybeans relaxed m/m from multi-year inversion levels even as 2020/21 ending stocks - the chief determinant of forward curves - were projected to shrink further. The market typically pauses prior to the March planting survey report that often sets the tone for overall price levels.

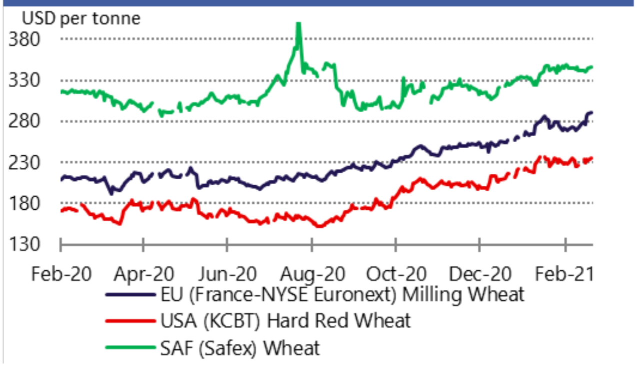
Investment flows

Managed money established its largest net long position in maize since 2011, while maintaining its large net long in soybeans and nearly neutral position in wheat. Commercials lightened their large net short positions slightly m/m in all three commodities.

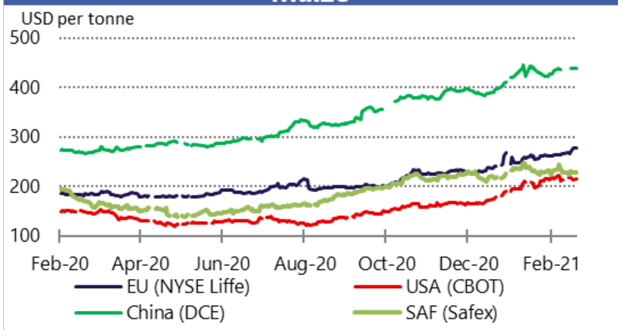
Market indicators

Daily quotations from leading exchanges - nearby futures

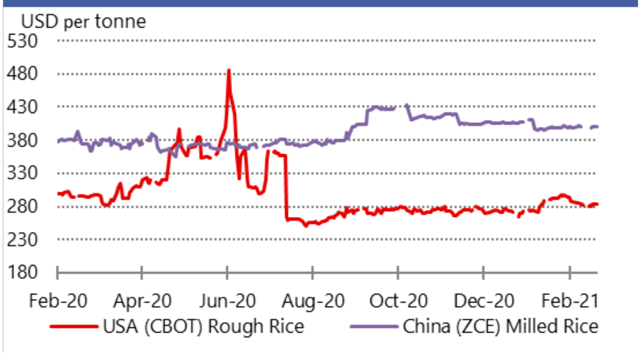
Wheat



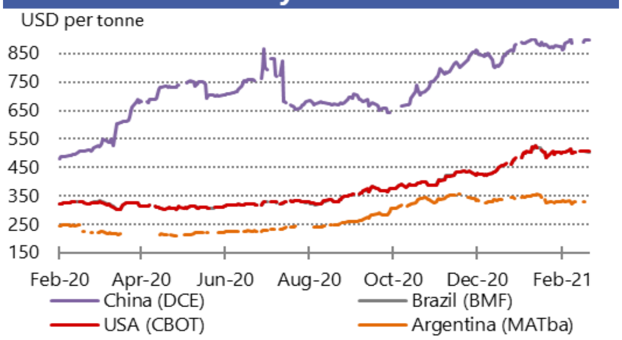
Maize



Rice

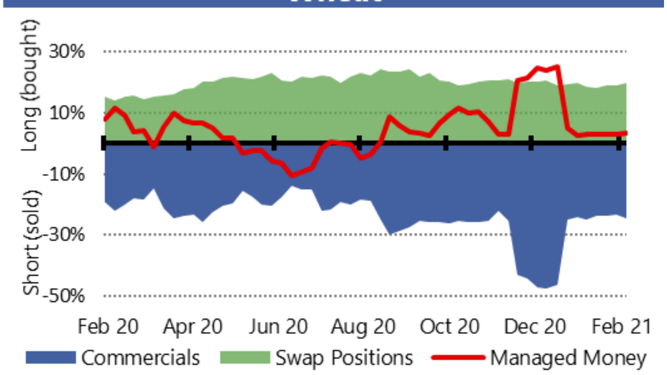


Soybeans

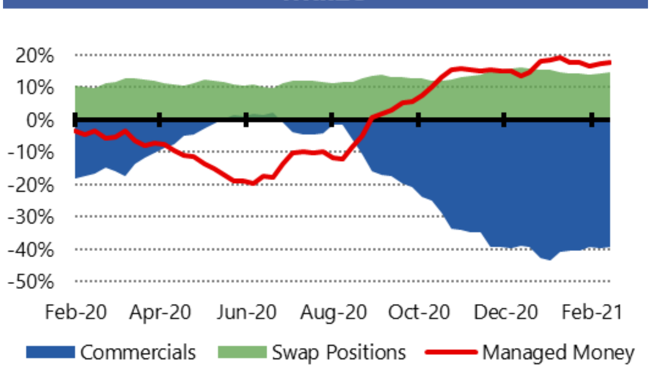


CFTC Commitments of Traders - Major Categories Net Length as percentage of Open Interest*

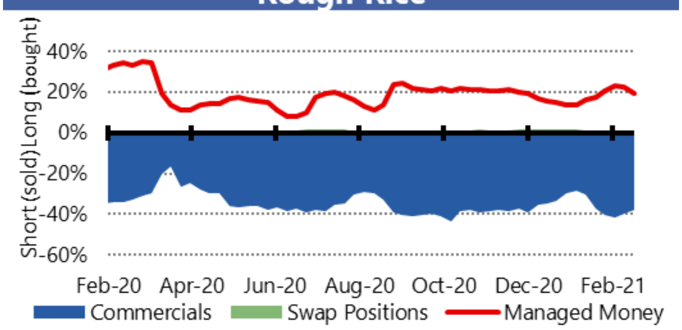
Wheat



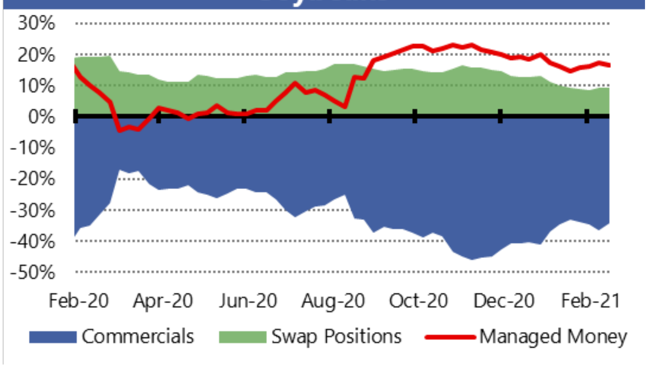
Maize



Rough Rice

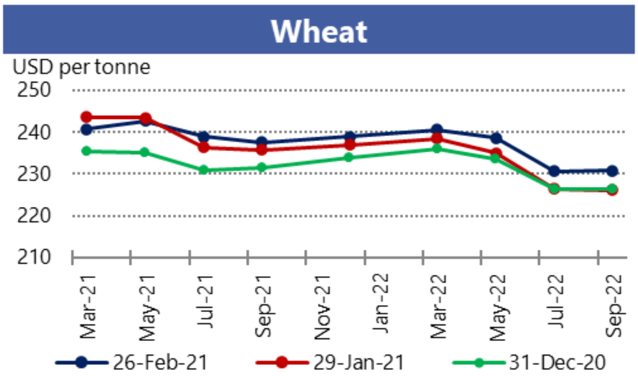


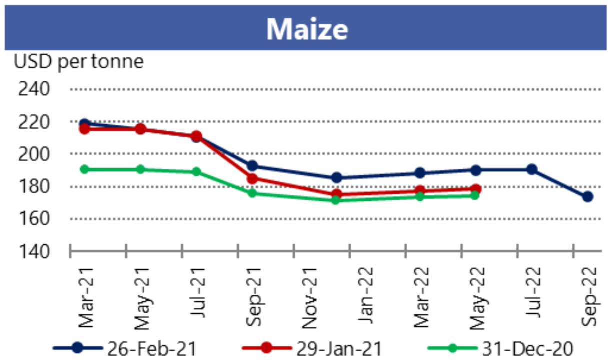
Soybeans

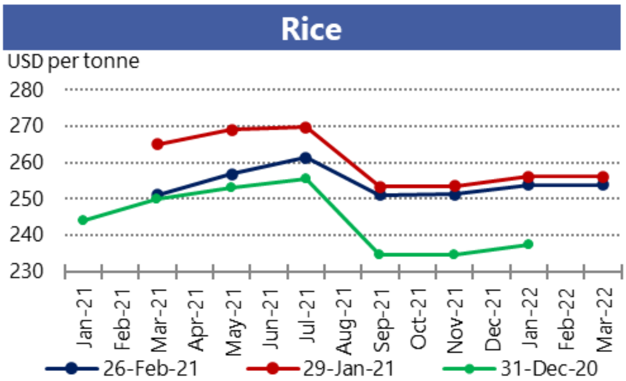


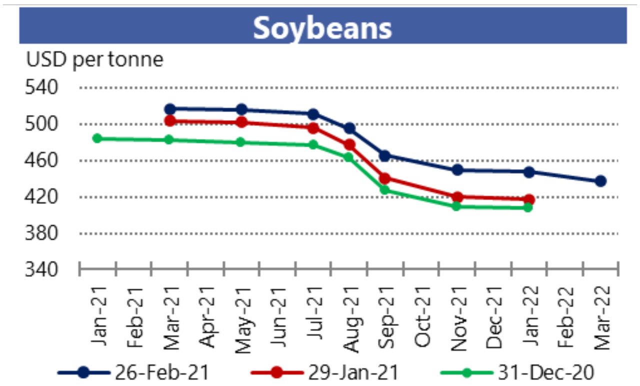
**Disaggregated Futures Only. Though not all positions are reflected in the charts, total long positions always equal total short positions.*

Forward Curves

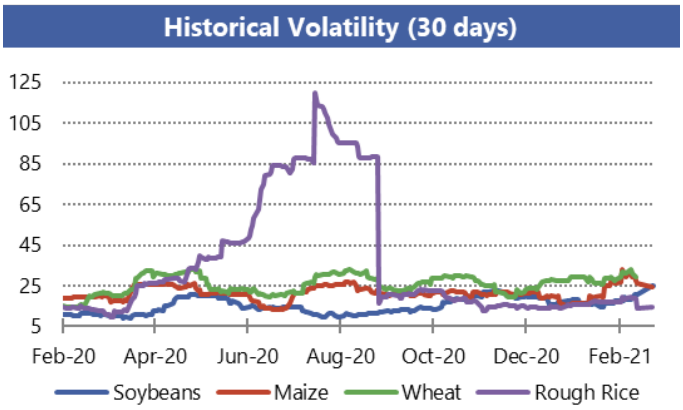


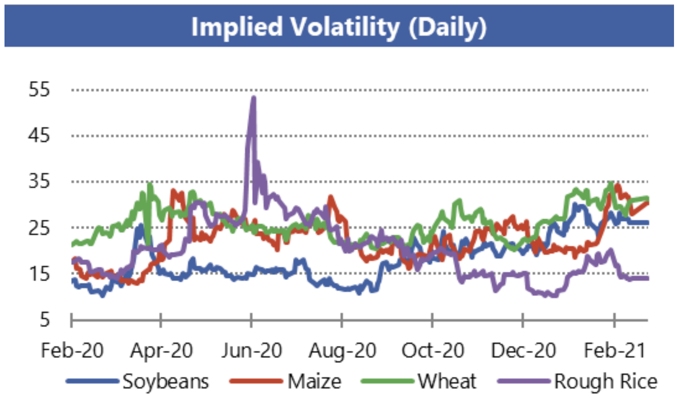






Historical and Implied Volatilities





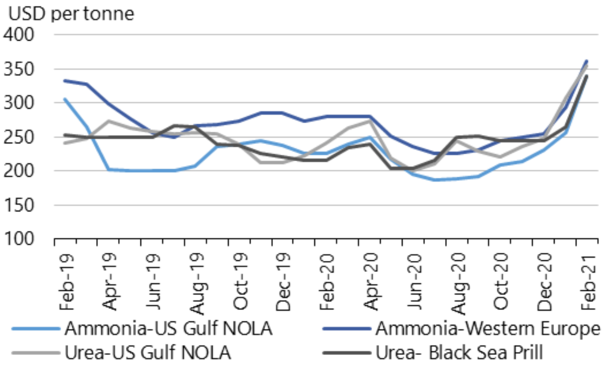
AMIS Market indicators

Some of the indicators covered in this report are updated regularly on the AMIS website. These, as well as other market indicators, can be found at: http://www.amis-outlook.org/amis-monitoring/indicators/

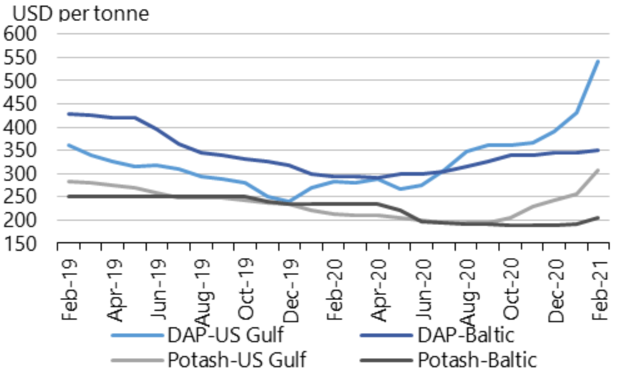
**For more information about Forward Curves see the feature article in No. 75 February AMIS Market Monitor 2020.*

Fertilizer outlook

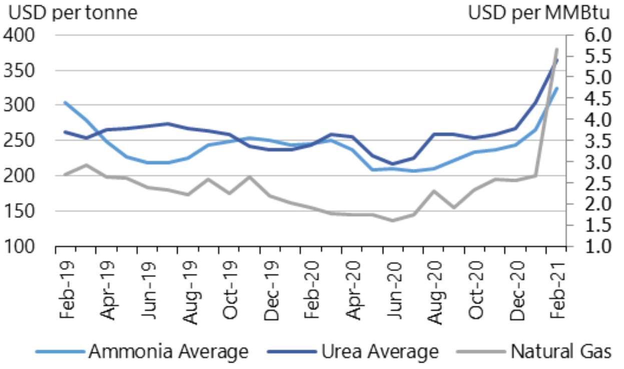
Ammonia and Urea
(Spot prices)



Potash and Phosphate
(Spot prices)



Ammonia Average, Urea Average and Natural Gas
(Spot prices)



Note: Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers.
Own elaboration based on Bloomberg.

- **Natural gas** prices more than doubled m/m due to cold weather in the Northern Hemisphere that pushed up energy demand for heating, combined with winter storms in the US that interrupted supply.
- **Ammonia prices** significantly increased m/m, reaching their highest values over the last 12 months, due to rising input (gas) costs, supply shortages due to production plants' maintenance, and a strong seasonal demand.
- **Urea prices** accelerated their upward trend due to a higher volume of early purchases in the US combined with low inventories.
- **DAP prices** markedly increased in the US due to a tight global supply of phosphates and limited imports.
- **Potash prices** also increased noticeably, especially in the US.

	February average	February std. dev	change last month*	change last year*	12-month high	12-month low
Ammonia-US Gulf NOLA	340.0	34.6	32.8%	51.1%	340.0	186.0
Ammonia-Western Europe	361.7	38.8	23.0%	29.2%	362.0	225.0
Urea-US Gulf	355.0	12.5	15.6%	47.3%	355.0	199.5
Urea-Black Sea	340.0	-	28.3%	57.2%	340.0	203.0
DAP-US Gulf	541.0	13.5	25.5%	91.5%	541.0	267.0
DAP-Baltic	350.0	-	1.2%	18.6%	350.0	291.0
Potash-Baltic	205.3	2.9	6.7%	-12.3%	234.5	190.0
Potash- US Gulf NOLA	307.0	22.3	19.5%	44.6%	307.0	193.0
Ammonia	323.4	26.2	21.8%	31.6%	323.4	206.5
Urea	365.0	5.0	19.9%	50.2%	365.0	217
Natural Gas	5.7	4.3	112.2%	197.6%	5.7	1.6

All prices shown are in US dollars.
Source: Own elaboration based on Bloomberg

Chart and tables description ** Estimated using available weekly data to date.*
Ammonia and Urea: Overview of nitrogen-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Western Europe and Black Sea. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.
Potash and Phosphate: Overview of phosphate and potassium-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Baltic and Vancouver. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.
Ammonia Average and Urea Average: Monthly average prices from Ammonia's US Gulf NOLA, Middle East, Black Sea and Western Europe were averaged to obtain Ammonia Average prices; monthly average prices from Urea's US Gulf NOLA, US GUlf Prill, Middle East Prill, Black Sea Prill and Mediterranean were averaged to obtain Urea Average prices.
Natural Gas: Henry Hub Natural Gas Spot Price from ICE up to December 2017 and from Bloomberg (BGAP) from January 2018 onwards. Prices are intraday prices averaged by month. Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers
DAP: Diammonium Phosphate.

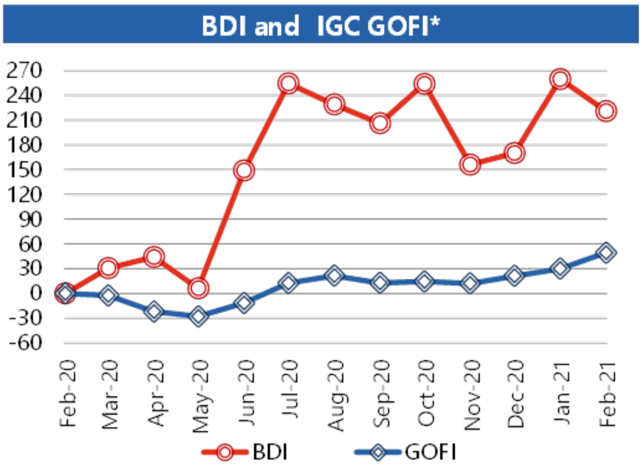
Ocean freight markets

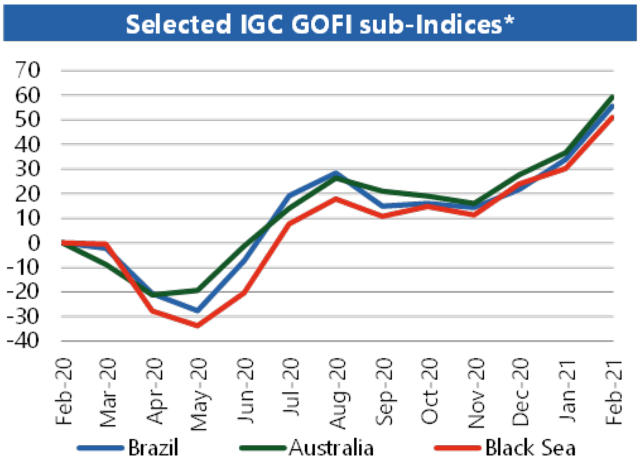
Dry bulk freight market developments

	February-21 average	Change m/m	y/y
Baltic Dry Index (BDI)*	**1478.7**	**-10.8%**	**+221.0%**
sub-Indices:			
Capesize	*1544.3*	*-40.9%*	*n/a*
Panamax	*1977.9*	*+24.3%*	*+193.1%*
Supramax	*1310.1*	*+19.9%*	*+155.1%*
Baltic Handysize Index (BHSI)**	*792.4*	+19.0%	+159.3%

Sources: Baltic Exchange, IGC.
*4 January 1985 = 1000. **23 May 2006 = 1000.
***1 January 2013 = 100.

	February-21 average	Change m/m	y/y
IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI)***	**151.2**	**+14.9%**	**+49.2%**
sub-Indices:			
Argentina	*184.6*	*+14.9%*	*+45.9%*
Australia	*99.1*	*+16.5%*	*+59.2%*
Brazil	*199.7*	*+16.2%*	*+55.5%*
Black Sea	*161.6*	*+16.0%*	*+51.0%*
Canada	*125.6*	*+14.1%*	*+45.8%*
Europe	*131.6*	*+12.5%*	*+50.4%*
US	*124.6*	*+13.4%*	*+43.9%*





*percentage change based on monthly average values

- Vessel hire rates in the grains and oilseeds carrying sectors rallied to multi-year highs during the past month, bucking seasonal trends. Nevertheless, with a steep fall in Capesize values, the **Baltic Dry Index (BDI)** averaged 11 percent lower compared to January.
- The **Capesize** Baltic sub-Index mostly declined during the month, with easing congestion in China and a slowdown in activity due to seasonal festivities in Asia contributing to the weak tone. However, solid Panamax gains offered support recently. Average Capesize earnings dropped by 41 percent m/m, but remained well above year ago levels, when the sub-Index turned negative against the backdrop of the evolving coronavirus pandemic.
- The **Panamax** market charged higher in the first half of February and reached a ten-year peak by mid-month, with activity centred on front-haul deliveries out of the US Gulf and the Black Sea region, where logistics were reportedly affected by wintry weather. Despite a recent retreat, average segment earnings were 24 percent higher m/m.
- Baltic Indices for **Supramax** and **Handysize** carriers climbed by 20 percent and 19 percent, respectively, to multi-year peaks. Upside in those markets was chiefly linked to brisk fixing in the Americas, tight vessel supply in Europe and the Mediterranean, as well as buoyant Chinese demand for Indonesian coal in the run up to Lunar New Year holidays.
- Recent sizeable gains in timecharter rates coincided with firming bunker prices, these recently climbing to one-year highs. Reflecting this, average **IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index** values rose by 15 percent in February, to their highest in at least eight years.

Source: International Grains Council

Baltic Dry Index (BDI): A benchmark indicator issued daily by the Baltic Exchange, providing assessed costs of moving raw materials on ocean going vessels. Comprises sub-Indices for three segments: Capesize, Panamax and Supramax. The Baltic Handysize Index excluded from the BDI from 1 March 2018.

IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI): A trade-weighted composite measure of ocean freight costs for grains and oilseeds, issued daily by the International Grains Council. Includes sub-Indices for seven main origins (Argentina, Australia, Brazil, Black Sea, Canada, the EU and the USA). Constructed based on nominal HSS (heavy grains, soybeans, sorghum) voyage rates on selected major routes.

Capesize: Vessels with deadweight tonnage (DWT) above 80,000 DWT, primarily transporting coal, iron ore and other heavy raw materials on long-haul routes.

Panamax: Carriers with capacity of 60,000-80,000 DWT, mostly geared to transporting coal, grains, oilseeds and other bulks, including sugar and cement.

Supramax/Handysize: Ships with capacity below 60,000 DWT, accounting for the majority of the world's ocean-going vessels and able to transport a wide variety of cargos, including grains and oilseeds.

Explanatory notes

The notions of **tightening** and **easing** used in the summary table of **"Markets at a glance"** reflect judgmental views that take into account market fundamentals, inter-alia price developments and short-term trends in demand and supply, especially changes in stocks.

All totals (aggregates) are computed from unrounded data. World supply and demand estimates/forecasts are based on the latest data published by FAO, IGC and USDA. For the former, they also take into account information provided by AMIS focal points (hence the notion **"FAO-AMIS"**). World estimates and forecasts produced by the three sources may vary due to several reasons, such as varying release dates and different methodologies used in constructing commodity balances. Specifically:

Production: Wheat production data from all three sources refer to production occurring in the first year of the marketing season shown (e.g. crops harvested in 2016 are allocated to the 2016/17 marketing season). Maize and rice production data for FAO-AMIS refer to crops harvested during the first year of the marketing season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season) in both the northern and southern hemisphere. Rice production data for FAO-AMIS also include northern hemisphere production from secondary crops harvested in the second year of the marketing season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). By contrast, rice and maize data for USDA and IGC encompass production in the northern hemisphere occurring during the first year of the season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season), as well as crops harvested in the southern hemisphere during the second year of the season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season) . For soybeans, the latter approach is used by all three sources.

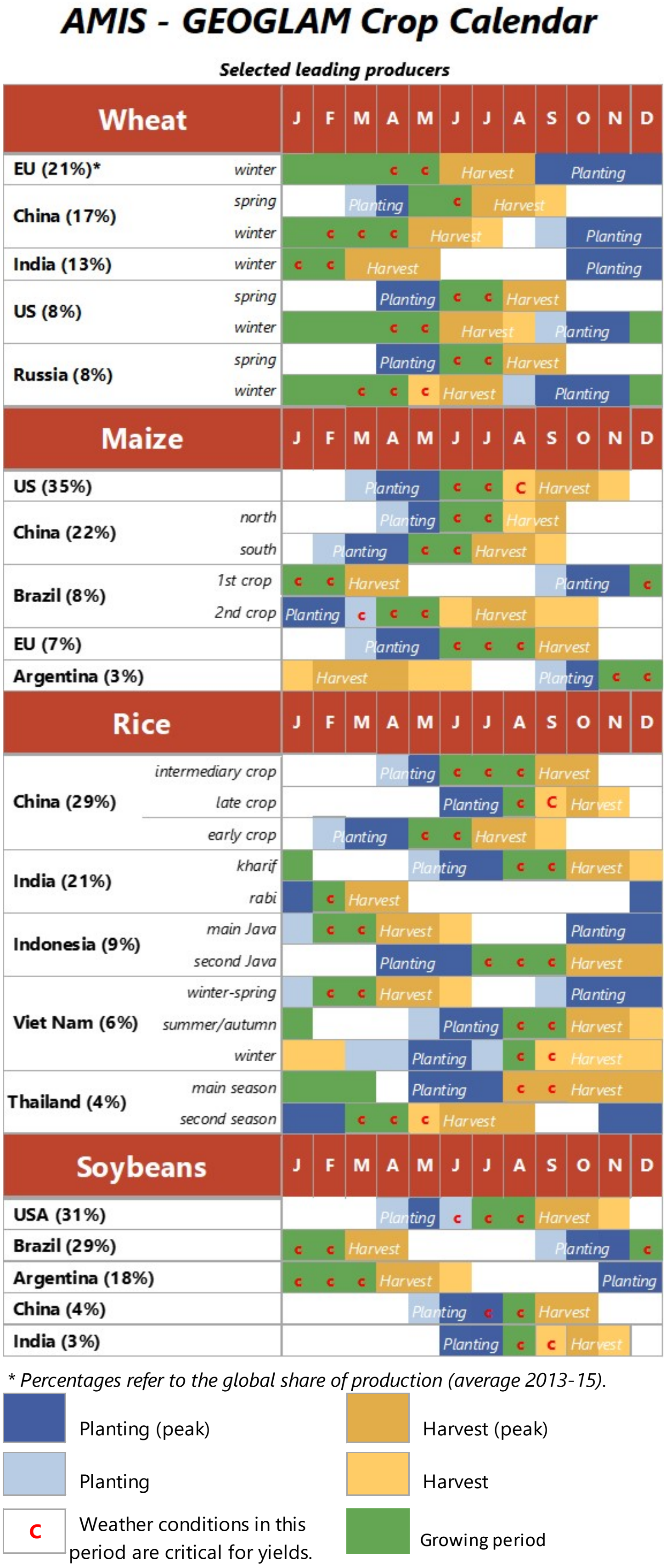
Supply: Defined as production plus opening stocks by all three sources.

Utilization: For all three sources, wheat, maize and rice utilization includes food, feed and other uses (namely, seeds, industrial uses and post-harvest losses). For soybeans, it comprises crush, food and other uses. However, for all AMIS commodities, the use categories may be grouped differently across sources and may also include residual values.

Trade: Data refer to exports. For wheat and maize, trade is reported on a July/June basis, except for USDA maize trade estimates, which are reported on an October/September basis. Wheat trade data from all three sources includes wheat flour in wheat grain equivalent, while the USDA also considers wheat products. For rice, trade covers shipments from January to December of the second year of the respective marketing season. For soybeans, trade is reported on an October/September basis by FAO-AMIS and the IGC, while USDA data are based on local marketing years except for Argentina and Brazil which are reported on an October/September basis. Trade between European Union member states is excluded.

Stocks: In general, world stocks of AMIS crops refer to the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country's national marketing year. For soybeans, stock levels reported by the USDA are based on local marketing years, except for Argentina and Brazil, which are adjusted to October/September. For maize and rice, global estimates may vary across sources because of differences in the allocation of production in southern hemisphere countries.

For more information on AMIS Supply and Demand, please view [AMIS Supply and Demand Balances Manual](#).



Main sources
Bloomberg, CFTC, CME Group, FAO, GEOGLAM, IFPRI, IGC, OECD, Reuters, USDA, US Federal Reserve, WTO

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